Two Fables from Aesop

Chapter One. The Fox and the Grapes.

A hungry fox saw some fine bunches of grapes hanging from a vine. The vine was trained along a high trellis. He did his best to reach them by jumping as high as he could.

But it was all in vain, for they were just out of reach. So he gave up trying, and walked away with an air of dignity. I thought those grapes were ripe, he said, but I see now they are quite sour.

Chapter Two. The Tortoise and the Hare.

A hare once made fun of a tortoise for being so slow. The tortoise laughed and said that he would win a race against him.

The hare soon ran far ahead, and lay down to take a nap. The tortoise plodded on and never stopped. When the hare woke up, the tortoise was already at the finish line.